

MUSIC

OVERVIEW

Music study at the Grade 11 and 12 level enhances students' understanding and appreciation of music through the development of practical skills and creative work. Students extend their creative problem-solving skills, individual and cooperative work habits, and knowledge of themselves and others. They develop a sense of personal responsibility and connections to their communities, and explore future careers.

Students use the elements of music (pitch – melody, harmony and tonality; duration – beat, metre, rhythm, and tempo; dynamics and other expressive controls; timbre; texture; and form) to create and perform works of increasing complexity. They use a variety of current technologies with increasing skill when practising, performing, composing, arranging, or recording music.

Performance and theory skills continue to be of major importance as students progress from grade to grade. Students extend their ability to evaluate performances by reviewing and reflecting and commenting on their own and others' creative work. They expand their specialized vocabulary for evaluating their own music and the work of other musicians.

The expectations for music courses are organized into three distinct but related strands:

1. ***Creating and Presenting:*** Students use the creative process (see pages 15–17) to apply their skills and knowledge of theory to performance and composition. Students develop their technical skill when performing individually and in ensembles (e.g., using voice, band instruments, string instruments, guitar, keyboards, or other performance media). They improvise, interpret, and compose music, using a variety of media, such as computers and other digital technology.
2. ***Reflecting, Responding, and Analysing:*** Using the critical analysis process (see pages 17–22) to enhance their appreciation of different types of music enables students to develop a deeper understanding of themselves and the communities in which they live. Students listen to and reflect on live and recorded performances to develop their understanding of the language of music and assess how effectively composers and performers communicate to their audience. Students explore the interrelationship between music and society, drawing on music from a range of cultures, including the rich heritage of Canadian music. Students also assess their interest, skills, and knowledge in relation to potential careers or continued study in music.

3. **Foundations:** In this strand, students enhance their knowledge of and their ability to apply the symbols, concepts, and conventions used in music. Students build on the vocabulary necessary for creating, performing, and evaluating music. This foundational study helps them expand their understanding of the development of different musical forms and the importance of health and safety practices. Students also develop their understanding of musical etiquette and of ethical issues that apply to both consumers and producers of music.

For policy guidelines pertaining to focus courses, see pages 12–13 of this document.

The list of approved focus courses for Music can be found at:

www.edu.gov.on.ca/eng/curriculum/secondary/arts.html.

Music, Grade 11

University/College Preparation

AMU3M

This course provides students with opportunities to develop their musical literacy through the creation, appreciation, analysis, and performance of music, including traditional, commercial, and art music. Students will apply the creative process when performing appropriate technical exercises and repertoire and will employ the critical analysis processes when reflecting on, responding to, and analysing live and recorded performances. Students will consider the function of music in society and the impact of music on individuals and communities. They will explore how to apply skills developed in music to their life and careers.

Prerequisite: Music, Grade 9 or 10, Open

A. CREATING AND PERFORMING

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- A1. The Creative Process:** apply the stages of the creative process when performing notated and/or improvised music and composing and/or arranging music;
- A2. The Elements of Music:** apply the elements of music when performing notated and improvised music and composing and/or arranging music;
- A3. Techniques and Technologies:** use a range of techniques and technological tools in a variety of applications relating to music.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

A1. The Creative Process

By the end of this course, students will:

- A1.1** apply the creative process when performing notated and/or improvised music (*e.g., explore and reflect on subtleties of balance and blend in the selection they are playing or singing; refine their performance of a baroque selection by adding ornamentation; evaluate the success of innovation and experimentation through self-assessment and by reflecting on input from teachers and peers*)

Teacher prompts: “How do you decide whether an improvisational exploration has been successful? What role, if any, do your peers play in this decision-making process?” “What roles do inspiration and innovation play when you improvise music?”

- A1.2** apply the creative process when composing and/or arranging music (*e.g., make an initial plan with respect to the form of their composition; experiment with different rhythms and articulation; demonstrate innovation in their choice of instruments in their arrangement, such as arranging a chorale or hymn melody for brasses; revise and refine their work in response to self-assessment and peer and teacher input; present their revised work to the class or the whole school*)

Teacher prompts: “How will your plans with respect to instrumentation affect your approach to this arrangement?” “When you are exploring approaches to your arrangement, how can input from the intended performers be valuable?” “Have you built enough time for reflection into the creative process? Why is this stage important?”

A2. The Elements of Music

By the end of this course, students will:

- A2.1** apply the elements of music and related concepts appropriately and effectively when interpreting and performing notated music (*e.g., demonstrate skills in phrasing, intonation, dynamics, tempi, rhythm, balance, and blend in repertoire and supporting exercises; play or sing with correct articulation increasingly complex melodic and harmonic patterns; provide shape to reflect the character of a melody; play or sing with tone colour appropriate to the style of music being performed*)

Teacher prompts: “How can input from peers with respect to timbre and expressive controls help you achieve appropriate balance and blend in your performance?” “Why is it important for all members of an ensemble to approach the elements of music in the same way?” “Was there disagreement in your ensemble about the approach to some elements of the selection? Why? How did the resolution affect the interpretation of the selection?”

- A2.2** manipulate the elements of music and related concepts appropriately and effectively when improvising melodies in a variety of musical forms (*e.g., when improvising four-bar diatonic melodies over appropriate accompaniment; when using forms such as rondo, call and response, theme and variations; when adding ornamentation to a melody to create variety in repeating passages; when improvising musical patterns using modes and scales from non-Western music*)

Teacher prompts: “In what ways does the effect of this selection differ when the rhythm or tempo is ‘swung’ rather than played ‘straight’?” “What types of variations could you make in dynamics to create interest and variety in repeating passages?”

A2.3 apply the elements of music and related concepts appropriately and effectively when composing and/or arranging music in a variety of forms (e.g., when creating rhythmic or melodic compositions in forms such as rondo or theme and variations; when creating melodies using a variety of modal scales; when composing a short work for brass ensemble and djembe)

Teacher prompt: “When approaching the element of pitch, how might you use dissonance to enhance your harmonic palette and add interest to your work? How can the use of modal scales affect the pitch of your composition?”

A3. Techniques and Technologies

By the end of this course, students will:

A3.1 demonstrate technical skills when performing increasingly complex notated and/or improvised music (e.g., perform notated music with accuracy and fluency; sight-read unfamiliar music with accuracy; perform complex studies and exercises to support repertoire; perform passages from technical exercises and repertoire demonstrating varying tempi; perform improvised music with fluency and appropriate expression)

Teacher prompts: “What must you do to maintain clear articulation in this exercise as your tempo increases?” “How does this study relate to the repertoire we are preparing in class? What particular skills does it target?”

A3.2 apply compositional techniques when composing and/or arranging music (e.g., create and/or arrange homophonic compositions in four or more parts, using technology where appropriate; include aleatoric aspects in a composition for a vocal performance or performance on their instrument; use simple polyphonic techniques to compose a short work for a small group; use vocables and strophes when composing a vocal composition in the style of a First Nation song; use techniques associated with raga and tala to compose a short work in an East Indian tradition)

Teacher prompts: “What techniques might you use to integrate repetition into your work and yet still keep the composition fresh?” “How might you use compositional techniques from other cultures? How might these enrich your work?”

A3.3 use a variety of current technologies in various applications related to music, including composing, arranging, performing, and/or recording music (e.g., use accompaniment software to accompany their solo performance; make a digital recording of a personal performance and distribute it using available technology; use a computer and appropriate software to record and edit a performance by a class ensemble; use a notation program when composing music or to arrange a composition to be played by the class; produce music using a loop-based mixing program)

Teacher prompts: “Identify all the technological devices in your home that can be used to play music. In what ways do these devices influence when and how you listen to music?” “How can using current technology help you become a more effective producer of music?”

B. REFLECTING, RESPONDING, AND ANALYSING

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1. The Critical Analysis Process:** use the critical analysis process when responding to, analysing, reflecting on, and interpreting music;
- B2. Music and Society:** demonstrate an understanding of social and cultural influences on and effects of traditional, commercial, and art music;
- B3. Skills and Personal Growth:** demonstrate an understanding of how performing, creating, and critically analysing music has affected their skills and personal development;
- B4. Connections Beyond the Classroom:** analyse opportunities and requirements for continued engagement in music.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

B1. The Critical Analysis Process

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1.1** deconstruct the elements and other components in musical works through score study and purposeful listening (e.g., *identify the individual elements of music in their performance repertoire and/or in aural selections, interpret their function, and analyse how the composer has manipulated them to create specific effects; analyse the form and effect of the first movement of a classical symphony, with reference to the repetition and variation of specific elements of music; identify and analyse the use of elements in improvised music*)

Teacher prompts: “How has the composer used the elements of music to create a sense of unity in this composition?” “Which elements do the musicians manipulate in their improvisation? What effect does this manipulation produce?”

- B1.2** listen in a purposeful way to selections from a wide variety of musical styles and genres, and analyse and reflect on their responses to and interpretation of them (e.g., *describe their personal preferences in music styles, with reference to characteristics and components of specific selections; analyse changes in their response to a selection from the baroque period, from initial reaction through reflection and ongoing interpretation; explain their interpretation of a selection*

from the traditional music of an Asian culture; describe their response to the original version of a classic blues recording and later covers of the same song, and explain the reasons for their response)

Teacher prompts: “When you reflect on the types of music that appeal to you, do you see similarities in the characteristics of the selections? What are these characteristics? Why do you think you are drawn to them?” “In what ways does your own cultural background influence your interpretation of music from another culture?”

- B1.3** analyse, and assess the effectiveness of, music from a variety of styles and genres and in various performance modes (e.g., *analyse the success or lack of success of the composer of an impressionist selection in achieving his or her artistic goal; explain how the aesthetic success of an improvised selection is related to the effectiveness of its manipulation of the musical elements; assess a performance by a professional musician who plays the same instrument or has the same voice type they do, and reflect on how it may influence their own performance*)

Teacher prompts: “What was Beethoven trying to convey in his Third Symphony? Do you think he was successful? Why or why not?” “How can your engagement with the critical analysis process affect your approach to the creative processes?”

B1.4 gather information from reliable sources on the background of music and musicians, audience responses, and music criticism, and analyse and reflect on the information to enhance their critical judgements and ongoing interpretations of music (e.g., *compare and contrast a variety of concert reviews of “new music”, including both positive and negative reviews; use contemporary reviews to identify the critical response to the premiere of a work by a historical musical figure, compare it to the present-day reception of that work, and conduct research into the historical context to determine reasons for the difference in the responses; reflect on responses from audience members and media critics, and apply the information to make improvements in their own performances*)

Teacher prompts: “In what ways does your understanding of the background of a musician and the reception of her or his music by the public influence your choices of performance repertoire?” “When you learned about the inspiration for this piece of music, did this knowledge affect your interpretation or assessment of the work? Why or why not?”

B2. Music and Society

By the end of this course, students will:

B2.1 analyse ways in which traditional, commercial, and art music are a response to and reflection of the community or culture in which they were created (e.g., *describe socio-economic influences on the chamber works of a specific period in Western music; compare traditional music of selected African cultures and spirituals of the antebellum American South, and give reasons for the similarities and differences; analyse the influences that technology has had on traditional music over the past half century; analyse how songs have drawn attention to various social causes or historical events*)

Teacher prompts: “What impact have socio-economic conditions had on the music of developing countries such as South Africa or India?” “What are some of the songs associated with the environmental movement? The civil rights movement? What was the social context for these songs?” “What was the origin and impact of Live Aid?”

B2.2 analyse the impact that significant individuals or groups from a variety of cultures (e.g., *African Guitar Summit, Joan Baez, Nadia Boulanger, Ry Cooder, Ella Fitzgerald, Peter Gabriel, Antonio Carlos Jobim, Ladysmith Black Mambazo, Clara Schumann*) have had on traditional, commercial, and/or art music

Teacher prompts: “How did J. S. Bach’s work influence composers from the baroque period and beyond?” “What impact did Helen Creighton have on traditional music in Canada?”

B2.3 analyse the interrelationships between traditional, commercial, and art music (e.g., *the influence of traditional and commercial music on the art music of George Gershwin; the use by pop songwriters from a variety of cultures of themes or melodies from art music; the integration of traditional blues riffs in rock ‘n’ roll; the impact of globalization on music*)

Teacher prompts: “What features did J. S. Bach borrow from music from his Lutheran heritage, and how did he integrate them into his music?” “What types of themes did Dvorak use in his *New World Symphony*?” “What traditional instruments are used in contemporary West African music?”

B3. Skills and Personal Growth

By the end of this course, students will:

B3.1 analyse the impact of the study of music on their personal growth (including the development of their values), their expressive capabilities, their awareness of social issues, and their understanding of other cultures (e.g., *their respect for the opinions, preferences, and creative abilities of others; their awareness of social issues addressed in protest music; their ability to express a range of emotions creatively; their understanding of and appreciation for the richness of different cultures*)

Teacher prompts: “In what ways has creating or analysing music affected your personal values?” “In what ways has analysing or performing music from other cultures affected your opinion of people from those cultures?”

B3.2 assess their musical skills and knowledge, and develop and implement a plan to ensure continued improvement (e.g., *use technology to record and review their studio and public performances, and assess those performances; identify areas for both aesthetic and technical improvement; develop and reflect on a creative or performance portfolio that exemplifies their output as a musician and demonstrates ongoing improvement*)

Teacher prompts: “What role does careful and analytical listening play in helping you improve your performance?” “Are you able to successfully record and edit your composition? If not, what other skills or knowledge do you need to acquire?” “What skills and artistic qualities are

you developing that signal your musical growth as a performer? In what areas do you need more practice?"

B3.3 demonstrate the interpersonal skills, work habits, attitudes, and qualities that are essential to the effective functioning of a musical ensemble (e.g., *personal responsibility and respect for others in performance and creative work, the ability to lead sectional rehearsals, the ability to balance the needs of the group with the needs of individual musicians*)

Teacher prompts: "What steps would you take in a small ensemble if there were conflict over musical interpretation or if members were unprepared?" "What are some strategies you have used to build consensus on musical goals in rehearsal?"

B4. Connections Beyond the Classroom

By the end of this course, students will:

B4.1 assess their interests, skills, and knowledge in relation to a variety of music-related careers (e.g., *create a reverse plan, from a music career they would like to pursue to their prospective educational pathway; summarize their skills, interests, and experience in a résumé that could be used to apply for work in a recording studio, music store, or musical theatre production; determine the skills and educational requirements of a range of jobs generated by the musical entertainment industry*)

Teacher prompts: "What skills, knowledge, and attitudes are required for work as a recording engineer? A disc jockey? A studio musician? What skills and/or knowledge would you have to acquire to work at one of these jobs?" "What skills and background does a professional classical musician require?" "What is the salary range for a member of a classical ensemble? How might a professional musician supplement this salary?"

B4.2 analyse the requirements for postsecondary study of music with respect to education and musical proficiency, and assess what they need to do to meet those requirements (e.g., *research university and college programs in music or music-related areas, and identify academic requirements for entry into these programs; assess their performance or creative proficiencies with respect to audition or portfolio requirements for application to postsecondary programs*)

Teacher prompt: "From your gap analysis, what areas would you need to focus on to meet the application requirements for a postsecondary musical theatre program? What sorts of experience or educational opportunities might you pursue outside the school system to help you succeed in your application?"

B4.3 analyse opportunities for, and explain the benefits of, continuing involvement in music and other arts, including opportunities associated with private or public arts organizations (e.g., *assess the funding support that is available through organizations that support the arts, and write a funding application to one of them; research possibilities for involvement in an ensemble, show, production, or other opportunity within the school or the community; analyse how community music events help keep the arts vibrant in their community/region*)

Teacher prompts: "What are the benefits for both the individual and the community of local opportunities for participation in amateur music events?" "What might be done to mitigate the differences between large urban centres and smaller towns or rural areas with respect to arts-related opportunities?"

C. FOUNDATIONS

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1. Theory and Terminology:** demonstrate an understanding of music theory with respect to concepts of notation and the elements and other components of music, and use appropriate terminology relating to them;
- C2. Characteristics and Development of Musical Forms:** demonstrate an understanding of the development, function, and characteristics of various forms of music;
- C3. Conventions and Responsible Practices:** demonstrate an understanding of conventions and responsible practices relating to music.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

C1. Theory and Terminology

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1.1** extend their understanding of the elements and other components of music, particularly through practical application and aural recognition, and use appropriate terminology related to these elements (*e.g., describe in detail elements of music as they relate to course repertoire and a broad range of aural examples; describe, recognize, and perform major, melodic and harmonic minor, whole tone, chromatic, and various blues scales; identify simple and compound intervals, as well as major, minor, and diminished triads; describe and demonstrate dominant, diminished, major, and minor seventh chords; describe and demonstrate cadences, including perfect, imperfect, and plagal; recognize various forms and aspects of form, such as strophic form, sonata form, refrain, motif, bridge, oratorio, vocables in Native American songs*)
- C1.2** demonstrate an understanding of, and use correct terminology related to, the concepts of notation in a variety of activities (*e.g., demonstrate an understanding of notational format and conventions involved in scoring for various small ensembles; use correct notation when arranging or transposing an existing polyphonic work of at least three parts/voices for a small ensemble; identify and notate sound layering in various voicings; use graphic notation to reflect environmental source material in a soundscape*)
- C1.3** accurately reproduce, notate, or identify melodic, harmonic, and/or rhythmic examples (*e.g., reproduce, aurally identify, and notate intervals from unison to an octave, including major, minor, diminished, and augmented intervals; notate melodies from four to eight measures in length; reproduce rhythm patterns and phrases related to their performance repertoire*)

C2. Characteristics and Development of Musical Forms

By the end of this course, students will:

- C2.1** demonstrate an understanding of the development and function and/or theme of various musical forms and conventions (*e.g., outline the part of the Catholic mass that best illustrates the use of cantus firmus; explain the use of overtures in opera and musical theatre; trace the development of instruments over time; create a CD of musical excerpts to illustrate the evolution of the concerto form*)
Teacher prompt: "After careful listening, what characteristics of this selection lead you to conclude that it is not a baroque orchestral composition?"
- C2.2** analyse, on the basis of research, and report on the characteristics of and ideas in traditional and contemporary music, including Aboriginal music, from Canada and around the world

(e.g., analyse shared characteristics of West African and Cuban music; research and report on connections between music and nature; interview a First Nation musician and share his or her experiences and perspectives with their peers)

Teacher prompts: “Why might the composer of a Renaissance madrigal have imitated the sounds of nature?” “What are some of the key themes in Aboriginal music in Canada? How do these themes compare to those in Aboriginal music in other countries?”

C3. Conventions and Responsible Practices

By the end of this course, students will:

C3.1 explain the importance of and demonstrate safe and healthy practices associated with practising, performing, and listening to music (e.g., ergonomic considerations associated with playing various instruments and using computers; connections between respiratory health and the rehearsal environment; safe sound levels in rehearsal and performance settings and when listening to recorded music)

Teacher prompts: “What are some common injuries or physical problems that musicians are subject to? What measures could they take to help reduce the incidence of these injuries?” “Why is it important for a vocalist to conduct warm-up exercises before a performance? What are some appropriate exercises?”

C3.2 explain and demonstrate conventions associated with various type of musical performance and production, from the perspective of a performer and an audience member (e.g., explain the differences in acceptable audience behaviour at the symphony, a jazz concert, a musical theatre production, and an outdoor rock event; demonstrate proper etiquette when performing solo or as part of an ensemble; prepare program notes for a musical theatre production or a classical concert)

C3.3 demonstrate an understanding of ethical and legal practices with reference to both consumers and producers of music, with particular emphasis on copyright issues (e.g., stage a mock trial in which they explain their rights as a performer, creator, and consumer of music; participate in a four-corner debate on issues related to downloading copyrighted music files)

Teacher prompts: “How are composers remunerated when their work is played on the radio? When it is downloaded from a website?” “Legally, what actions are advertisers supposed to take before using a composer’s music in a commercial?”